

Absolutely — **bread** is a good example where we should be **exhaustive in checking**, but **conservative in splitting meanings**. The bare noun itself has only a few genuinely useful modern senses, but the family has some strong extensions such as **breaded**, **breadcrumbs**, **breadwinner**, plus the slang sense **bread = money**.

Your passage uses:

> “The aroma of freshly baked **bread** was drifting out onto the street...”

Here **bread** simply means **food made mainly from flour and liquid, usually baked after making dough**.

Word family: **bread / breaded / breadcrumb / breadwinner**

Base word: bread

Verb: bread, breaded, breading

Related forms: breadcrumb, breadwinner

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞)

Meaning in your passage: **bread = baked food made from dough — 麵包**

Your sentence:

> “The aroma of freshly baked **bread** was drifting out onto the street.”

Here **bread** means:

> **food made mainly from flour and water or another liquid, formed into dough and usually baked.**

繁體中文：

主要以麵粉和水等材料製成麵糰，再經烘焙製成的食物；麵包

Natural translation:

> “The aroma of freshly baked bread was drifting out onto the street.”

「新鮮出爐**麵包**的香氣飄到街上。」

So here:

> **bread = 麵包**

1. **bread = bread as food — 麵包**

The core and overwhelmingly most common meaning.

Practice 1 — Original

> “The aroma of freshly baked **bread** was drifting out onto the street.”

「新鮮出爐**麵包**的香氣飄到街上。」

Practice 2

> “They bake fresh **bread** every morning.”

「他們每天早上都烘焙新鮮**麵包**。」

Practice 3

> “Would you like some bread with your soup?”

「你的湯要不要配一些**麵包**？」

****bread = 以麵粉製成麵糰，再經烘焙等方式製成的主食類食品****

Usually ****uncountable**** when talking about bread generally:

> some bread

> fresh bread

> bread and butter

Not normally:

> *a bread* ❌

when you simply mean one loaf.

2. ****bread = a type/kind of bread — 麵包種類****

Although normally uncountable, ****bread**** can become countable when referring to ****different varieties****.

Practice 4

> “The bakery sells several traditional ****breads****.”

「這間麵包店出售幾種傳統****麵包種類****。」

Practice 5

> “Wholegrain and sourdough are two popular breads.”

「全穀麵包和酸種麵包是兩種受歡迎的****麵包種類****。」

****breads = 不同種類 / 做法的麵包****

So:

> bread = 麵包這類食物

> breads = 不同種類的麵包

This is a useful countability shift, not a wholly different lexical meaning.

3. ****bread = food/livelihood in a broader symbolic sense — 生計；糧食****

A figurative/traditional extension.

Practice 6

> “For many families, this work puts ****bread**** on the table.”

「對很多家庭來說，這份工作提供了****生計 / 養家收入****。」

Practice 7

> “People need secure work to earn their daily bread.”

「人們需要穩定工作來賺取****日常生計****。」

****bread — figurative = 維持生活所需的基本食物，進一步引申為生計 / 養活自己的收入****

This meaning survives mainly in fixed or semi-fixed expressions.

4. ****bread = money (俚語) — 錢；鈔票****

A genuine modern slang meaning.

Practice 8

> “He’s trying to earn more **bread**.”

「他正努力賺更多**錢**。」

Practice 9

> “That job brings in good bread.”

「那份工作能賺不少**錢**。」

****bread — slang = money****

Register:

- * informal/slang
- * especially associated with older or stylized slang
- * not suitable for formal writing

This is a completely different high-value MCQ sense.

5. ****bread = verb, coat food with breadcrumbs — 裹麵包糠****

A major culinary verb use.

Practice 10

> “****Bread**** the chicken before frying it.”

「炸雞之前先給雞肉****裹上麵包糠****。」

Practice 11

> “The fish was breaded and baked.”

「魚塊裹了****麵包糠****後烘烤。」

****bread — verb = 在食物表面裹上一層麵包糠，通常再煎、炸或烘焙****

This is genuinely distinct from the noun.

6. ****breaded = coated with breadcrumbs — 裹麵包糠的****

Practice 12

> “They serve ****breaded**** chicken strips.”

「他們供應****裹麵包糠的****雞柳。」

Practice 13

> “The breaded fish is baked rather than fried.”

「這款****裹了麵包糠的魚****是烘焙而不是油炸。」

****breaded = 食物表面已裹上麵包糠的****

7. ****breadcrumbs = 麵包糠；麵包屑****

A strong family extension.

Practice 14

> “Sprinkle ****breadcrumbs**** over the pasta.”

「在意粉上撒一些****麵包糠****。」

Practice 15

> “There were breadcrumbs all over the table.”

「桌上到處都是****麵包屑****。」

****breadcrumbs = 麵包碎屑；烹飪中通常指經處理後用來裹食物或作配料的麵包糠****

Context determines:

* 麵包屑

* 麵包糠

8. ****breadcrumb = navigation trail in websites/software — 麵包屑導覽；導覽路徑****

A major technology extension.

Practice 16

> “Use the **breadcrumb** trail to return to the previous section.”

「使用**麵包屑導覽**返回上一層。」

Practice 17

> “The page shows breadcrumbs at the top.”

「頁面頂部顯示了**導覽路徑**。」

breadcrumb — computing = 顯示使用者目前所在網站 / 系統層級位置的一串導覽連結

Example conceptually:

> Home > Products > Bakery > Bread

This is called:

> breadcrumb navigation

because it metaphorically resembles leaving a trail of breadcrumbs.

Excellent family-extension polysemy.

9. **breadcrumb** = small clue/trail of information — 小線索；資訊痕跡

A figurative technology/investigation extension.

Practice 18

> “The logs left digital **breadcrumbs** that helped investigators.”

「系統紀錄留下了一些數碼**線索 / 資訊痕跡**，幫助調查人員。」

Practice 19

> “Each message provided another breadcrumb.”

「每則訊息都提供了另一個**小線索**。」

****breadcrumb — figurative = 可以一步步引導人找到答案 / 來源的小線索****

This comes from the “trail of breadcrumbs” metaphor.

10. ****breadwinner = main income earner — 家庭主要經濟支柱；主要養家者****

A very useful family extension.

Practice 20

> “She became the family’s main ****breadwinner****.”

「她成為家庭的主要****經濟支柱 / 養家者****。」

Practice 21

> “After he lost his job, his partner became the sole breadwinner.”

「他失業後，他的伴侶成為家庭唯一的****經濟支柱****。」

****breadwinner = 為家庭賺取主要生活收入的人****

The metaphor is:

> earn the bread → support the household

11. ****bread-and-butter = basic source of income / core activity — 主要收入來源；核心業務****

A highly useful fixed compound.

Practice 22

> “Birthday cakes are useful, but bread is the bakery’s ****bread-and-butter business****.”

「生日蛋糕雖然有用，但麵包才是這間店的****核心業務 / 主要收入來源****。」

Practice 23

> “Routine repairs are the company’s bread and butter.”

「日常維修是這家公司的****主要收入來源****。」

****bread and butter / bread-and-butter = 維持收入最基本、最穩定的工作 / 業務****

This is idiomatic, so I would keep it in the expression layer rather than treat it as a bare-**bread** sense.

12. ****bread-and-butter = basic/ordinary/mainstream — 基本的；常規的****

A second extension of the same expression.

Practice 24

> “These are standard ****bread-and-butter**** services.”

「這些都是標準的****基本 / 常規服務****。」

Practice 25

> “The shop focuses on bread-and-butter products with steady demand.”

「這間店專注於需求穩定的****基本主力產品****。」

****bread-and-butter = 最基本、最常規、最可靠的****

Important distinction: ****bread vs loaf****

****bread****

= 麵包這種食物，通常不可數

****loaf****

= 一整條 / 一整個麵包

> some bread

> = 一些麵包

> a loaf of bread

> = 一條 / 一個麵包

So:

> **a bread** ❌ usually

> a loaf of bread ✓

Important distinction: **bread vs bun**

Your passage also contains **bun**.

bread

broad category.

bun

usually:

a small individual roundish bread item.

So:

> all buns are broadly bread products,

> but not all bread is a bun.

Natural Chinese:

* bread = 麵包

* bun = 小圓麵包 / 包類, depending on context

Important distinction: **bread vs pastry**

Your passage also contains **pastries**.

bread

typically based on dough whose structure is bread-like, often yeast-fermented.

pastry

typically richer dough made with flour and fat, often flaky/crumby.

Examples:

* sourdough = bread

* croissant may be treated commercially as pastry despite being yeast-leavened

* tart shell = pastry

For learner purposes:

> bread = 麵包類

> pastry = 酥皮 / 糕點類

The categories can overlap technically, but everyday usage distinguishes them.

Important distinction: **bread vs cake**

bread

normally staple baked dough product.

cake

typically sweet, softer/richer baked product.

> bread = 麵包

> cake = 蛋糕

But English names can blur this boundary:

* banana bread

* fruitcake

So naming conventions are not always chemically neat.

Important distinction: **bread vs dough**

dough

= uncooked mixture before baking.

bread

= finished food.

> dough rises

> = 麵糰發酵膨脹

> bread is baked

> = 麵包烘焙完成

Important distinction: **bread vs toast**

bread

= 麵包

toast

= bread browned by heating/toasting.

> slice of bread

> = 一片麵包

> slice of toast

> = 一片烤麵包 / 多士

Important distinction: **bread vs breadcrumbs**

bread

= whole food/product

breadcrumbs

= tiny broken/dried pieces of bread

> breadcrumbs for frying

> = 裹炸用麵包糠

Important distinction: **breadcrumb — food vs computing**

Food:

> breadcrumbs

> = 麵包糠 / 麵包屑

Computing:

> breadcrumbs

> = 顯示網站層級位置的導覽路徑

Completely different domain.

Excellent MCQ contrast.

Important distinction: **bread** — food vs slang money

Food:

> “I bought some bread.”

= 我買了一些麵包。

Slang:

> “He needs more bread.”

Depending on context:

= 他需要更多**錢**。

Context is essential.

Important distinction: **breadwinner** vs **businessman**

You have **business** mapped now.

breadwinner

= person who earns the household's main income.

businessperson

= person engaged professionally in business.

A breadwinner does not have to be a businessperson.

For example:

a nurse can be the family breadwinner.

Important distinction: ****fresh bread vs freshly baked bread****

****fresh bread****

= 新鮮麵包

****freshly baked bread****

= 剛烘焙完成的麵包

Your passage uses the more specific:

> ****freshly baked bread****

which emphasizes:

> 剛出爐

Important grammar note: ****bread is usually uncountable****

Natural:

> some bread

> much bread

> a loaf of bread

> two slices of bread

Not normally:

> ***two breads***

unless referring to:

> two varieties/types of bread.

So:

> "We sell six breads."

can mean:

> 六種麵包

especially in bakery/culinary contexts.

Important grammar note: common units of bread

Useful countable units:

* **a loaf of bread** = 一條 / 一個麵包

* **a slice of bread** = 一片麵包

* **a piece of bread** = 一塊麵包

* **a chunk of bread** = 一大塊麵包

These do not create new meanings of **bread**; they solve its normal uncountability.

Important note on polysemy depth

Unlike **business**, **bread** does **not** have a huge number of unrelated common bare-word meanings.

The genuinely useful lexical inventory is mainly:

1. **bread = food**
2. **bread = varieties of bread** through countability shift
3. **bread = livelihood/basic sustenance** mainly in fixed expressions
4. **bread = money** in slang
5. **bread — verb = coat with breadcrumbs**

Then the richest additional value comes from family extensions such as:

- > breadcrumb
- > breadwinner
- > bread-and-butter

So we should **not** manufacture extra senses simply because bread appears in many different food contexts**.

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern family includes:

* **bread — food** = 麵包

* **bread — varieties** = 各種麵包
 * **bread — livelihood** = 生計 / 基本生活來源
 * **bread — slang money** = 錢
 * **bread — verb** = 裹麵包糠
 * **breaded** = 裹麵包糠的
 * **breadcrumbs — food** = 麵包屑 / 麵包糠
 * **breadcrumb — computing** = 麵包屑導覽 / 導覽路徑
 * **breadcrumb — figurative clue** = 小線索 / 資訊痕跡
 * **breadwinner** = 家庭主要經濟支柱
 * **bread-and-butter — income** = 主要收入來源 / 核心業務
 * **bread-and-butter — basic** = 基本 / 常規的

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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bread — food	主要以麵粉和液體製成麵糰，再經烘焙等方式製成的麵包類食物
breads	不同種類 / 做法的麵包
bread — livelihood	維持基本生活所需的食物 / 收入，常引申為生計
bread — slang	非正式俚語中的「錢」
bread — verb	在食物表面裹上一層麵包糠
breaded	食物表面已裹上麵包糠的
breadcrumbs — food	細小麵包碎屑或烹飪使用的麵包糠
breadcrumb — computing	顯示使用者目前網站 / 系統層級位置的導覽連結
breadcrumb — figurative	能逐步引導人找到答案或來源的小線索
breadwinner	為家庭賺取主要生活收入的人
bread-and-butter — income	維持一個人 / 企業最基本且穩定的收入來源
bread-and-butter — basic	最基本、最常規、最可靠的

For your original sentence

> “The aroma of freshly baked **bread** was drifting out onto the street...”

The exact meaning is:

**bread = Golden Crust 剛烘焙出爐、由麵糰製成的麵包類食品；freshly baked 強調「剛出爐」。
 **

Natural translation:

> **「新鮮出爐麵包的香氣飄到街上。」**

The highest-value contrasts are:

- > **bread** → 麵包
- > **a loaf of bread** → 一條 / 一個麵包
- > **different breads** → 不同種類的麵包
- > **earn one's bread** → 賺取生計
- > **bread — slang** → 錢
- > **bread chicken** → 替雞肉裹麵包糠
- > **breadcrumbs** → 麵包屑 / 麵包糠
- > **breadcrumb navigation** → 麵包屑導覽
- > **breadwinner** → 家庭主要經濟支柱
- > **bread-and-butter business** → 核心 / 主要收入業務